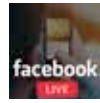




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SOME TECHNICAL ROLES IN THE INDUSTRY

1. IoT SME (Subject matter expert)/ Consultant
2. Device Expert
3. IoT Architect
4. Data Scientist
5. Product Manager - IoT Software & Ecosystem
6. Embedded & IoT Application Engineer

track a lot of data for you that you or a health expert can analyse. So yes, there is a bigger market for consumer devices that is growing,” says Dr. Kaustubh Nande, Country Marketing Head, ANSYS India.

How to Prepare

Frankly speaking, there is a dearth of dedicated IoT training, especially at school and college level. Traditional curriculums do not contain IoT specific knowledge. That being said, there are certain advantages in being from the correct stream of learning. “There is no specific degree on IoT yet. However, given the breadth and depth of expertise that might be needed in IoT applications, some qualification or understanding of technology is required. I think you can segment IoT skills mainly into core engineering skills that could span across a number of technical areas. And naturally other skills related to the business of IoT would also be helpful if you’re thinking of making a career in IoT related segments,” says Dr. Kaustubh Nande. For example, if you want to enter IoT device manufacturing, skills in electrical, electronics and instrumentation engineering will be highly advantageous. A computer science background is a big plus for working in IoT data analytics, mobile apps and UI development. There might be more specialised offerings going forward. As Mr. Bhavin Shah puts it, “IoT could be considered as a separate discipline. Basic understanding of how the IoT Ecosystem – Cloud, Fog Computing, Data analytics, Gateways, Edge devices, etc along with what “Smart” actually means. Further, introduction to Smart Home, Smart Buildings, Smart

Cities, Smart Health, Smart Energy, Smart Retail, Smart Manufacturing, etc. will help technical enthusiasts take up IoT as a career and contribute innovative solutions to the IoT industry”.

Distinctly there are two stages of skilling yourself in IoT while you wait for traditional curriculums to change –

1. Self-training : There is no dearth of training available online in the segments mentioned above. Some really good platforms offer lots of free resources in Data Analysis, Mobile Application development, UI/UX development and more. Sitting through hours of videos might seem like a boring prospect, but some of these courses are actually designed to be assignment based. Some good resources are:

- a. Data: <http://dgit.in/DataScnc>
- b. Mobile: <http://dgit.in/MbileDev>
- c. UI: <http://dgit.in/UXDesgn>

2. DIY and Projects: There is no better way to learn than practical experience. Either take up IoT related topics as a school or college project, or if you are the self motivated kind, start your own personal pet project. DIY videos online are really helpful, along with a huge amount of support from the maker community. In fact, there are makerspaces and maker hubs created to help people learn IoT skills and build something on their own. Also, there is a huge marketplace for components now, readily available for the enthusiast. So go out there, buy those sensors and get working.

“There are so few people who know what to do, that IoT enabled candidates are commanding a 20-30% greater compensation than usual. For example, a 2 year experienced guy with the right

IoT skills can earn around 6lpa now, which they most likely wouldn’t in traditional industries. Since there is a need for specific skills right now, this will continue until these skills have greater availability”, says Dr. Sumit, CEO – Gaia Smart Cities. He continues, “We are investing in increasing the available pool of skills. Like I had 8 students working



Acer Cloud Professor is a kit to get started on building IoT for the cloud

with us over the summer, who were working on several technologies. Post their term, they would go back to their colleges and share their learnings as well as awareness about the skills needed in the IoT industry. At an industry level, NASSCOM is doing something good with the Centre of Excellence for IoT to encourage startups.” Things are definitely afoot to spread IoT’s reach wider and deeper.

In Conclusion

Don’t make the mistake of assuming IoT is an Industry in itself. In that way, it is more similar to the IT services industry where work depends on demands from other industries. And it wouldn’t be a surprise if it follows the same ups and downs that the IT industry has gone through, with the potential game-changer in both being automation. Ironically, IoT itself makes the individual trackable and accountable, as it provides unit level data in any process where it is implemented.

This particular field right now is all about learning things yourself. Until universities and colleges wake up and alter their curriculums to provide a much more standardised way of learning, keep the tinkerer in you alive. **[4]**

TOOLS IN THE INDUSTRY

Languages and Platforms:

- R Language
- Node.js
- Angular 2
- Websocket
- MQTT
- CoAP
- XMPP

Cloud Platforms:

- ThingWorx
- Buddy
- DataStax
- Arrayent
- PeoplePower
- Evrythng

Courtesy: Mr. Bhavin Shah, Founder & EVP Sales & Marketing at Volansys